

Ideal Customer Profile worksheet

This worksheet is a launchpad for creating your perfect ICP. We've included an example ICP throughout.

STEP 1

Map & Segment Your Customers

Questions to consider as you're segmenting your customers:

- Who are my existing or potential customers?
- What is the typical size of these companies?
- What industries and regions do they belong to?
- What technologies do they use?
- How would I rank these segments based on the likelihood of buying my product?

Customer Mapping & Segmentation

	Industry	Location	Sales Cycle	Company Size	Installed Base	Competitors
CUSTOMER SEGMENT EXAMPLE	Food and Beverage	United States	3–4 months	5k+	Salesforce.com	Startups A, B, C + Incumbents
CUSTOMER SEGMENT 1						
CUSTOMER SEGMENT 2						
CUSTOMER SEGMENT 3						

STEP 2

Understand Their Core Problem

Questions to consider to better understand your customers:

- What are your customer’s top pain points and challenges?
 - What is the status quo? How are they dealing with that problem now?
- How does this existing approach impact the business at large? Think of customers, sales, partners, etc.
 - Do they understand that this problem exists? Why or why not?

Value Proposition			
Pain Point	Status Quo	Consequences	Impact

Trade Promotion Management	Forms built within Salesforce.com	Inventory inconsistencies across retail customers	Out-of-Stock / Loss of Revenue
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Map Your Buying Personas

- Who are the roles typically involved in your buying process?
- Are they decision makers (Economic Buyer), users, technical buyers and/or influencers (sponsors/detractors)?
- What is their performance measured by? How does that align with the broader goals of their organization?
- How can your service/product support this persona with their goals and challenges?

Buying Personas			
Role	Buying Influence	Individual Goals	Impact
Head of Sales	Economic Buyer	Revenue Growth	Real time transparency over inventory

STEP 4

First Sales Meeting

The first meeting with your customer helps qualify the project timeline. It's a great opportunity to ask the right questions and better manage the resources (costs & people) that will be allocated to your customer.

Try to gather all the main stakeholders around the table when possible. Where are they in the decision process?	
Are they developing a similar solution internally and just want to have more inspiration from your solution?	
How can you shorten the sales cycle? That's why it's important to gather all stakeholders (IT for implementation, head of department using your solution, finance or procurement to negotiate a global framework...)	
Will this customer project require extra development (specific features/adaptation)? Can you afford these extra costs?	
Does it make sense to demonstrate your solution if the decision maker isn't attending the meeting?	